Est

The Est Merch Way

CORE PROCESS · ORDER FLOW · DRAFT V0.1

September 24, 2026
8 stages · 56 Printavo statuses
Draft — expect amendments

HOW TO READ IT

Each row is one stage of an order's life. The coloured tags are the **real Printavo statuses** in their real calendar colours. The right-hand column is the **seat that acts** — not the person who happens to be nearest.

THE FINDING

Stage 4 has **no Printavo status.** Receiving, counting and staging happen every day and are invisible in the system. That is why nobody owned it, and why it quietly drifted onto whoever was most willing.

1	***Quote*** Sales owns the number	Quote · MOCK-UP REQUESTED · MOCK-UP READY · QUOTE APPROVAL SENT · QUOTE APPROVED Build the quote off the matrix. Mock-up is an **art-team** function even though it lives in the sales phase — Sales requests, Art builds, Sales sends it personally.	**Sales & Marketing** Luke → Carrie Art: Richie CX: Clint
2	***Source Goods*** Money before blanks	ORDER GOODS · CONTRACT - WAITING ON GOODS Deposit collected before blanks are purchased. PO raised against the approved quote.	**Sales & Marketing** Sourcing Finance: deposit
3	***Art to Print-Ready*** The #1 failure point	PROOF REQUESTED · GXS — REQUEST · GXS — COMPLETE · ART APPROVAL SENT · ART APPROVED · ARTWORK DECLINED Route by the **art triage rule**: simple proofs and clean vector go to GXS; multi-logo layouts, redraws and client-spec layouts stay in-house. Richie QCs everything GXS returns.	**Pre-Press & Art** Richie owns GXS = capacity
4	***Receive, Count & Stage*** NO STATUS EXISTS	MISSING FROM PRINTAVO Goods received, counted in and laid out by order, ready to print. **Count-in standard:** under 300 pieces counted exact; 300 and over counted to the packing slip. Staged as a flow — as a job leaves for press, the space it frees takes the next one.	**Operations** Justin owns crew hours
5	***Pre-Production*** Screens, stitches, transfers	SP - PRE-PRO · EMB - ORDER DIGITIZING · EMB - PRE-PRO · DTF - ORDER TRANSFER · DTF - PRE-PRO · STORE - PRE PRO Screens burned and racked **for the next day's schedule before Richie leaves.** Digitizing ordered and sew-out approved. Transfers ordered.	**Pre-Press & Art** Richie owns EMB sew-out: Bryan
6	***Ready & Run*** Blocked on the calendar	SP - READY · SP - IN PRODUCTION · EMB - READY · EMB - IN PRODUCTION · DTF - READY · DTF - IN PRODUCTION · STORE - IN PRODUCTION Printavo block sweep sizes and places every job automatically. Justin sequences the day off the calendar and **calls print-or-stage for the last hour at the morning meeting.**	**Operations** Justin runs the day Press: Tom · Jerry EMB/DTF: Bryan
7	***QC & Fulfil*** Count out = count in	SP - COMPLETED · EMB - COMPLETE · DTF - COMPLETE · STORE - READY TO SHIP · READY FOR PICK UP · SHIPPED - BILLABLE · PICKED UP Misprints counted and recorded against the job — not absorbed. Folded, bagged, boxed. EasyPost label or pickup notice.	**Operations** Fulfilment: Kim Justin accountable
8	***Invoice & Close*** Cash, then the relationship	INVOICED · PAID & DONE · FEEDBACK REQUESTED Invoice same day as ship. AR chased on terms. Feedback request is the front end of the **reorder** — retention is the largest number in the business.	**Finance & Admin** Mechelle: AR/AP CX: Clint

THE FOUR HARD STOPS

1 · NO GOODS WITHOUT A DEPOSIT
Blanks are not purchased on a promise. Stage 1 → 2.

2 · NO SCREENS WITHOUT ART APPROVED
Burning ahead of approval is how we pay for a job twice. Stage 3 → 5.

3 · NO PRESS WITHOUT A COUNT
A job goes to press staged and counted, or it does not go. Stage 4 → 6.

4 · NO INVOICE WITHOUT COUNT OUT
Out must match in. Misprints are recorded, never absorbed. Stage 7 → 8.

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Why It Is Drawn This Way

CORE PROCESS · RATIONALE & EXCEPTIONS

September 24, 2026

THE ONE CHANGE THAT MAKES THE CHART REAL

ADD A STATUS FOR STAGE 4

Proposed: **GOODS RECEIVED → STAGED & READY TO PRINT**, sitting between ORDER GOODS and the PRE-PRO family.

Right now an order jumps from ORDER GOODS straight to SP - PRE-PRO, so the single most error-prone step in the shop — ***is everything here, is it the right count, is it laid out*** — leaves no trace. You cannot schedule against it, measure it, or hold a seat to it.

Two statuses turn the staging accountability from a line on an org chart into something the calendar and the Scorecard can both see.

WHERE THE HANDOFFS ARE, AND WHY

HANDOFF	WHY IT SITS THERE
Sales → Art at Mock-Up Requested	Mock-ups are an art function living inside a sales stage. Sales requests it, Art builds it, **Sales sends it** — the customer never hears from two voices.
Art → GXS at Proof Requested	GXS is capacity Richie directs, not a replacement for him. He decides what routes out and QCs everything that comes back. The triage rule protects the flat fee from jobs it was never priced for.
Sales → Operations at goods arrival	Sourcing ends when the boxes land. Everything after that — count, stage, print, pack — is one chain under one seat, so a problem found at count-in has a single owner.
Art → Operations at Pre-Pro complete	Screens racked for tomorrow **before Richie leaves**. The handoff is a physical rack, not a conversation, which is what makes it survive a 1pm departure.
Operations → Finance at ship or pickup	Invoice goes out the same day the goods do. Every day of delay here is a day of AR.

THE EXCEPTION LANE

STATUS	WHO ACTS	THE RULE
ARTWORK DECLINED	Pre-Press & Art	Back to Richie, not to the customer. Revision count tracked — three or more on one job means the brief was wrong, not the artist.
EMB SEW OUT DECLINED	EMB / Bryan	Re-digitize before re-sewing. A declined sew-out is a digitizing fault until proven otherwise.
ORDER ON HOLD - ISSUE	Operations → CX	Anyone can set it; **only Customer Success clears it**, and only after the customer has been told. A hold nobody communicated is a hold that becomes a complaint.
GXS - MISSING ATTACHMENT	Pre-Press & Art	Same-day fix or pull the job back in-house. A stalled proof at GXS is worse than no GXS.

LANES THAT RUN ALONGSIDE, NOT THROUGH

LANE	WHY IT IS SEPARATE
PROMO	Decorated by the supplier. Burns none of our production capacity and is excluded from the block sweep entirely. Paper-pushing and margin, not shop time.
STORE	Status-detected, never imprint-detected — store orders carry imprint rows that read "Screen Print, 0 colors" regardless of how they are actually decorated. The STORE family is the only reliable signal.
CONTRACT	Same production chain, different front end: no sourcing, no customer art conversation. Waiting-on-Artwork and Waiting-on-Goods are the two places contract jobs stall.

WHAT TO AMEND BEFORE THIS GOES TO THE TEAM

- **Reconcile against Order Playbook v7.3.** That doc already maps owners and automations to every status — written before the seats were redrawn. Where the two disagree, this chart is newer but the playbook knows the automations.
- **Decide the stage-4 status names** and whether it is one status or two.
- **Confirm who clears ORDER ON HOLD.** Drawn here as Customer Success; today it is whoever notices.
- **BD and UGP SHIPPED** are not placed on this flow — confirm whether they are still live or should be retired.
- **Sourcing sits under Sales & Marketing** on this draft. If it should move to Operations, stage 2 changes owner and the deposit gate moves with it.

Built from the 56 live Printavo statuses (pulled 24 Sept 2026), the v1.2 Accountability Chart, and the decisions made in this build: art triage to GXS · next-day screens · count-in standard · print-or-stage called at the morning meeting.